

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1572

By Sparks

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Wired Human for its leadership in addressing the youth mental health crisis and promoting healthy digital engagement among young people.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly recognize that the mental health and well-being of Tennessee's youth are essential to the strength and future of this State; and

WHEREAS, emerging data reveals that depression and anxiety related to technology use have tripled over the past decade, underscoring a growing public health concern; and

WHEREAS, studies indicate that 54 percent of young adults aged eighteen to twenty report having experienced online sexual harms during childhood, highlighting the urgent need for awareness, protection, and education; and

WHEREAS, teenagers now spend an average of nine hours per day engaged with digital media, and adolescents who spend more than three hours daily on social media are twice as likely to experience anxiety and depression; and

WHEREAS, today's hyper-connected youth are often described as one of the loneliest generations, with excessive digital engagement and the erosion of deep, meaningful relationships contributing significantly to this condition; and

WHEREAS, major technology companies generate billions of dollars annually through youth engagement, including an estimated \$11 billion in advertising revenue derived from users aged 0 to 17 across major social media platforms; and

WHEREAS, in response to these challenges, Wired Human, founded by Jason Frost and Lisa Frost, has become a leading nonprofit organization dedicated to advocating for a healthier digital future by equipping, educating, and empowering youth, parents, educators, and policymakers; and

WHEREAS, the organization provides both awareness and actionable solutions through its RUMB model—Relationship, Understanding, Mentorship, and Boundaries—helping young people identify their values and align their daily behaviors accordingly; and

WHEREAS, Wired Human's approach emphasizes empowerment rather than fear, avoiding shame-based messaging and instead fostering resilience, personal responsibility, and meaningful human connection; and

WHEREAS, the organization has developed an innovative curriculum for middle school students, currently under consideration for pilot implementation in six schools in Rutherford County, which would mark the curriculum's first adoption within a public school system following successful use in private-school settings; and

WHEREAS, Wired Human further elevates youth voices through artistic expression, encouraging students to create original works that reflect their lived experiences within the digital landscape, some of which have been displayed before members of the United States Senate as part of national advocacy efforts; and

WHEREAS, Wired Human will host a community art exhibition and reception at Trellis & Vine Art Gallery on Saturday, April 25, 2026, providing an opportunity for youth, parents, educators, and legislators to engage with these important issues and explore solutions together; and

WHEREAS, through its youth coalitions and community initiatives, Wired Human continues to provide critical support and guidance to families, educators, and leaders seeking to address the challenges of mental health and digital overexposure among today's youth; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that the members of this General Assembly honor and commend Wired Human

for its outstanding contributions to improving youth mental health and promoting a healthier, more balanced relationship with technology.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we applaud Wired Human's commitment to empowering the next generation through education, mentorship, creative expression, and practical solutions that foster long-term well-being.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we honor Wired Human's initiatives to equip young people with the necessary tools to thrive in an increasingly digital world.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.